On the origin of functions by means of natural selection and other processes

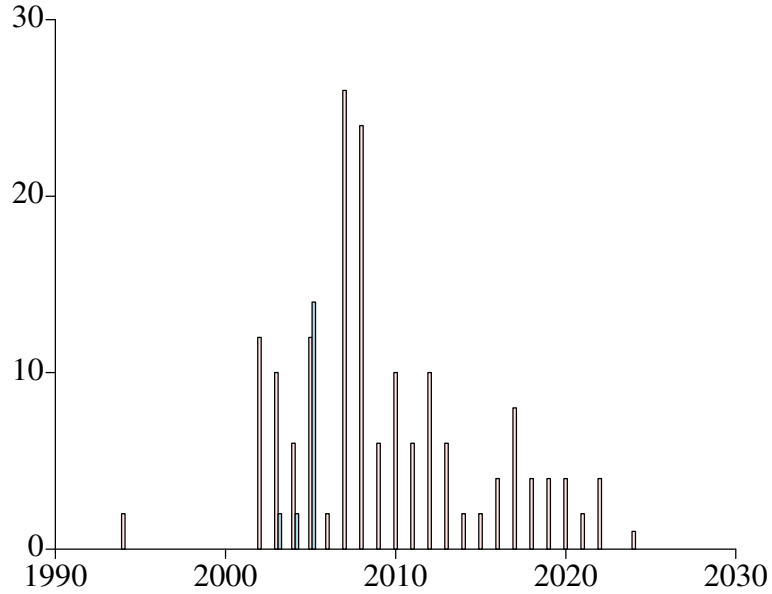
Sigfrid Lundberg

ABSTRACT

I at least try to write my paper before I write my abstract, because I hardly ever know what to summarize before I've written it. This in itself is most likey to be seen as a shortcoming, but be that as it may.

Introduction

If we are to believe Amie L. Thomasson, then many ontological and metaphysical theories have passed their best-before dates. Her arguments are that current ontology is far too complex (Thomasson, 2016) and that metaphysics itself is basically broken (Thomasson, 2026), and that it therefore must be made *functional* again. By functional she does not mean that someone should repair metaphysics but that the old quinean ontology (Quine, 1948) should be replaced with one that don't list existing things but investigate their functions.

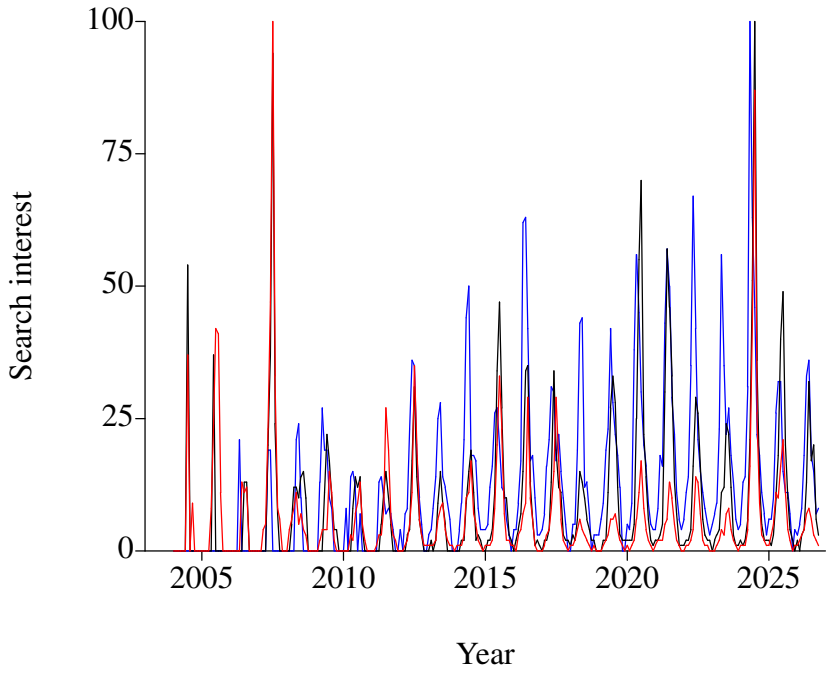


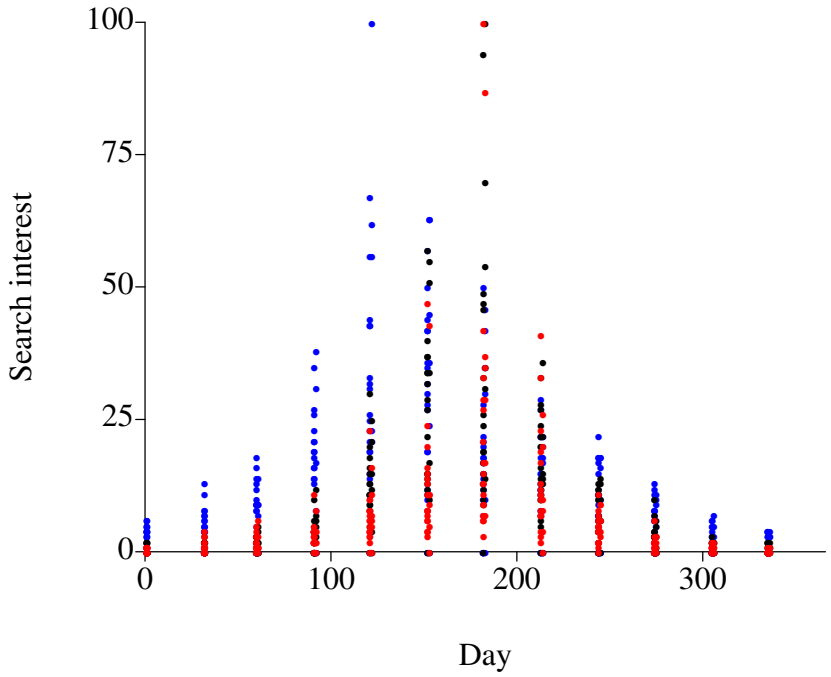
References

Quine, Willard V., "On what there is," *The Review of Metaphysics* **2**, pp. 21-38 (1948). https://www.jstor.org/stable/20123117.

Thomasson, Amie L., "Easy Ontology and the Work of Metaphysics" in *Metaphysics,* Royal Institute of Philosophy, London (2016). https://youtu.be/AbMtCIbBZNU.

Thomasson, Amie L., "Metaphysics Has Stopped Working—Making Metaphysics Functional" in *Making Metaphysics Functional,* Ergo (2026). https://youtu.be/Pl-9tD6qgEo.


100
75
50
25
0
Search interest
2005
2010
2015
2020
2025
Year


100
75
50
25
0
Search interest
0
100
200
300
Day